# Wael Shahadeh

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## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

**Marist University** Poughkeepsie, NY
*Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity* *Expected May 2027*
Minors: Computer Science, Information Systems, Information Technology, Criminal Justice

**CompTIA Security+** October 2026

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Languages:** Python, Bash, PowerShell
**Security Tools:** Wireshark, Nmap, eslogger (Endpoint Security Framework), SpriteTree
**Systems:** macOS, Windows Server, Active Directory, Linux (Kali, Ubuntu, Mint), Proxmox, VirtualBox
**Networking:** TCP/IP, DNS, routing and switching (CCNA coursework), Tailscale, Cloudflare, AdGuard Home

## PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

**Security Homelab & Self-Hosted Platform | wael.sh** 2025 – Present

- Built an environment on Proxmox, separating a Tailscale-only management plane from Cloudflare-fronted public services.
- Deployed AdGuard Home for network-wide DNS filtering, blocking ads, trackers, and known-malicious domains.
- Analyzed Cloudflare logs to investigate anomalous inbound traffic to a public API endpoint, classifying it as untargeted internet background scanning rather than a targeted attack.

**GDDC Blue Team Defense Competition** April 2026

- Received team MVP award; team placed 5th of 11 defending a simulated compromised corporate network across service uptime, business injects, CTF challenges, and executive interviews.
- Hardened firewall rules and removed rogue cron jobs used for attacker persistence on compromised hosts.
- Built a 7-VM VirtualBox practice environment from scratch for preparation, resolving routing conflicts, credential and GRUB recovery, and dependency issues.

## EXPERIENCE

**Undergraduate Researcher, Malware Detection**, *Marist University* October 2025 – Present

- Built behavioral training data for a LightGBM-based macOS malware detection model by detonating ~20 live samples across 2 families (adware, stealers); the model achieved a ~90% detection rate in controlled testing.
- Execute live samples in an isolated lab (macOS endpoints, Ubiquiti Dream Machine Pro, Faronics Deep Freeze) for safe detonation and repeatable data collection.
- Collect and analyze eslogger telemetry with SpriteTree to identify behavioral indicators of malicious activity.

**Cyber Security Specialist Instructor**, *OpenHub Project* June 2026 – Present

- Developed Security+ and CySA+ curriculum for adult career-changers entering cybersecurity, covering security operations.
- Designed and led hands-on projects, from initial scoping through completion, for 15 learners transitioning into tech roles, including diagnosing and repairing home devices.
- Taught cybersecurity fundamentals and practical AI tooling such as Gemini and Claude for phishing detection to learners with non-technical backgrounds.

**Resident Assistant**, *Marist University* August 2024 – Present

- Serve as first point of contact for 50+ residents and share on-call coverage for 270+, conducting health and safety inspections, wellness checks, and incident documentation with Residence Life.

**Intern, PC Repair**, *Marist University* October 2025 – December 2025

- Diagnose and refurbish 5 donated PCs daily, installing OSes and troubleshooting hardware issues.
- Collaborate with other interns to optimize imaging workflows and device repair processes.

## LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

**External Outreach Board Member**, *Cybersecurity Club, Marist University* January 2026 – Present

- Arranged an IBM site tour for 20 club members through direct outreach to an IBM executive.
- Coordinate conferences between the Cybersecurity Club and outside organizations.